Digital Literacy Project Report

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Year: 1st Year
Course Code: CSE0001
Date:30/3/2026

Introduction

This project was completed as part of my Digital Literacy course, where I took on the role of a Student Digital Ambassador. The main objective was to spread awareness among my peers about important aspects of the digital world, such as using online tools effectively, communicating professionally, and staying safe from cyber threats. In today's fast-paced digital environment, these skills are becoming essential, and this project gave me a chance to explore them practically.

Through the five structured tasks, I worked with different platforms and tools that are commonly used in academics and professional settings. Each task helped me understand how these tools function and how they can be applied in real-life situations, whether it is creating content, collaborating with others, or managing information.

One of the most valuable takeaways for me was learning how to build and maintain a professional digital presence. I also became more aware of the importance of responsible online behavior and cybersecurity. Overall, this project not only improved my technical knowledge but also strengthened my communication skills and critical thinking. It has made me more confident in using digital platforms and better prepared for future academic and career challenges.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic

For this task, I used Canva to design a digital literacy infographic that could clearly communicate important ideas in a simple and engaging way. I focused on key topics such as safe internet practices, useful digital tools for students, and the importance of maintaining a professional online presence. Canva was very helpful because it provided ready-made templates, icons, and color options, which made it easier to organize the content and make the design visually appealing.

While working on the infographic, I realized that the biggest challenge was not creating the design itself, but deciding how to present the information clearly and concisely. Digital literacy covers many concepts, and fitting all the important points into a single page without making it look cluttered was difficult. I had to carefully select only the most relevant information and use simple language so that anyone could understand it quickly.

I also paid attention to using colors and layout effectively, so that different sections were easy to identify at a glance. This task helped me improve both my creativity and communication skills. It taught me how to present complex ideas in a simple visual format, which is a very useful skill for academic presentations and future projects.

Reflection

I found it interesting how much thought goes into a single-page design. The challenge was fitting meaningful content into a visual format without making it cluttered. I initially tried to include too many points, and the infographic felt overwhelming. I learned to prioritise — to ask, 'What are the three most important things a first-year student needs to understand about digital literacy?' and build around those. What I found most difficult was choosing icons that matched my message without looking out of place. It took several iterations before the final layout felt balanced and readable

Task 2 – Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created and updated my profiles on LinkedIn, GitHub, and Kaggle to start building a strong digital presence. Each platform serves a different purpose, and together they help me grow both academically and professionally. On LinkedIn, I added my education details, including my B. Tech Bioengineering degree, and plan to use it for professional networking. Over time, I will share my achievements, certifications, and experiences to reflect my progress and connect with seniors and industry professionals.

GitHub is mainly for showcasing technical work. I created a profile README that includes my basic details and what I aim to learn in the coming years. As I continue my studies, I plan to regularly upload my coding projects, experiments, and any bioengineering-related work to build a strong and visible portfolio.

Kaggle is a platform I chose to explore data science and machine learning. It allows me to work with real-world datasets, practice my skills, and learn from others. I also plan to participate in competitions and share my notebooks there.

Over the next four years, I aim to actively use all these platforms to track my learning journey, improve my skills, and build a professional identity that will help me secure internships and future career opportunities.

Task 3 – Platforms Exploration

For this task, I explored both coding and collaboration platforms to understand how they can support my academic learning. For coding practice, I used HackerRank and completed a beginner-level problem. Although it was simple, it helped me understand the basics of programming logic, such as how to take input, process it, and produce the correct output. It also gave me confidence to start practicing more problems in the future.

For the collaboration part, I created a Google Form as a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz and connected it to Google Sheets to view and analyze the responses. This helped me understand how data is automatically collected, organized, and updated in real time. I also learned how to design clear and simple questions so that the responses would be meaningful.

These tools are very useful for students, especially in group projects and technical subjects. Platforms like HackerRank help in building coding skills step by step, while Google Forms and Sheets make teamwork more organized and efficient. Learning to use these tools early will definitely help me in future assignments, projects, and even research work.

Task 4 – Email Etiquette

In this task, I worked on writing two professional emails—one to request an extension for an assignment and another to express interest in an internship opportunity. While doing this, I understood how important it is to follow proper email etiquette. Simple things like writing a clear subject line, using a polite and respectful tone, and organizing the content properly can make a big difference in how the message is received. I also learned the importance of starting with a proper greeting and ending with a professional sign-off.

This task made me realize that digital communication is not just about sending information, but also about how you present it. Poorly written emails can easily create confusion or leave a negative impression. For example, sending a vague or informal email to a professor might make it seem disrespectful or careless. On the other hand, a well-written email shows professionalism and seriousness.

Overall, this task helped me improve my communication skills and made me more confident in writing formal emails. I now understand that clear and respectful communication is essential not only in academics but also in future professional environments.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

While researching cybercrime, one thing that really stood out to me was that many scams don't rely on advanced hacking or complicated technology. Instead, they take advantage of simple human mistakes, lack of awareness, or situations where people feel rushed or pressured. For example, in UPI fraud cases, scammers don't break into accounts—they simply trick users into approving a payment by making it look like they are receiving money. Realizing how easily this can happen was quite surprising and a bit concerning.

This made me understand that staying safe online is not just about having good technology, but also about being careful and aware as a user. Even a small moment of carelessness or confusion can lead to financial loss. It showed me how important it is to stay calm and think before taking any action online.

Because of this, I plan to change one important habit in my daily digital usage. I will make sure to carefully read every payment request and notification before approving it, instead of acting quickly. I will also avoid trusting unknown people, especially if they try to create urgency. Most importantly, I will never share my OTP or UPI PIN with anyone. This awareness will help me stay more secure and confident while using online platforms.

Conclusion

Overall, this project helped me clearly understand how important digital literacy is in today's world. Before starting, I had a basic idea of using online tools, but through these tasks, I learned how to use them more effectively and responsibly. From creating visual content and building a professional online presence to practicing coding and understanding online safety, each part of the project added something valuable to my learning.

I also realized that digital literacy is not just about technical skills, but also about how we communicate and behave online. Writing professional emails, managing online profiles, and being aware of cyber threats are all essential skills for students today. This project helped me become more confident in using digital platforms in a smart and organized way.

These skills will definitely support me throughout my academic journey, especially in assignments, group projects, and presentations. In the long run, they will also help me build a strong professional identity and prepare me for future career opportunities.
Overall, this was a very practical and useful learning experience that I can apply in real life

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